

Administrator Manual — Tracker Porti

🇮🇹 Manuale in italiano: [manuale_admin.md](#) · [index.html](#)

Guide to the functions reserved for Tracker Porti **administrators**: user and group management, coverage-map controls, risk model, system logs, and editing configuration files.

This manual **complements** the [User manual](#), which covers day-to-day use of the app. Here you'll find **only** what is reserved for administrators. For common features (monitoring, followed ships, ship detail, notifications, export...) refer to the user manual.

Administrator role

Administrators see the **Admin** link at the top right, which opens the **administration page** (/admin). An administrator can:

- **approve** pending new registrations;
- **enable or disable** an account;
- **change a user's role** (regular user ↔ administrator ↔ tester);
- **reset a user's password** — generates a **one-time link** (valid 24 hours) to hand to them;
- **delete** a user;
- **create and manage user groups** (see below);
- **impersonate** a user — view their areas, monitoring, and followed ships in **read-only** mode, with a prominent banner and one-click exit;
- consult the **logs** (activity log and API log), shared and visible only to administrators.

Settings managed by administrators (data sources, sanctions/PSC screening, risk-score weights) are **global** for all users. In the Settings interface, the tabs and toggles reserved for administrators are **hidden** from regular users (and protected server-side regardless).

User groups

An administrator can put several users into a **group**. When a user is part of a group, they **share with the other members** (as a **union** of what each one had):

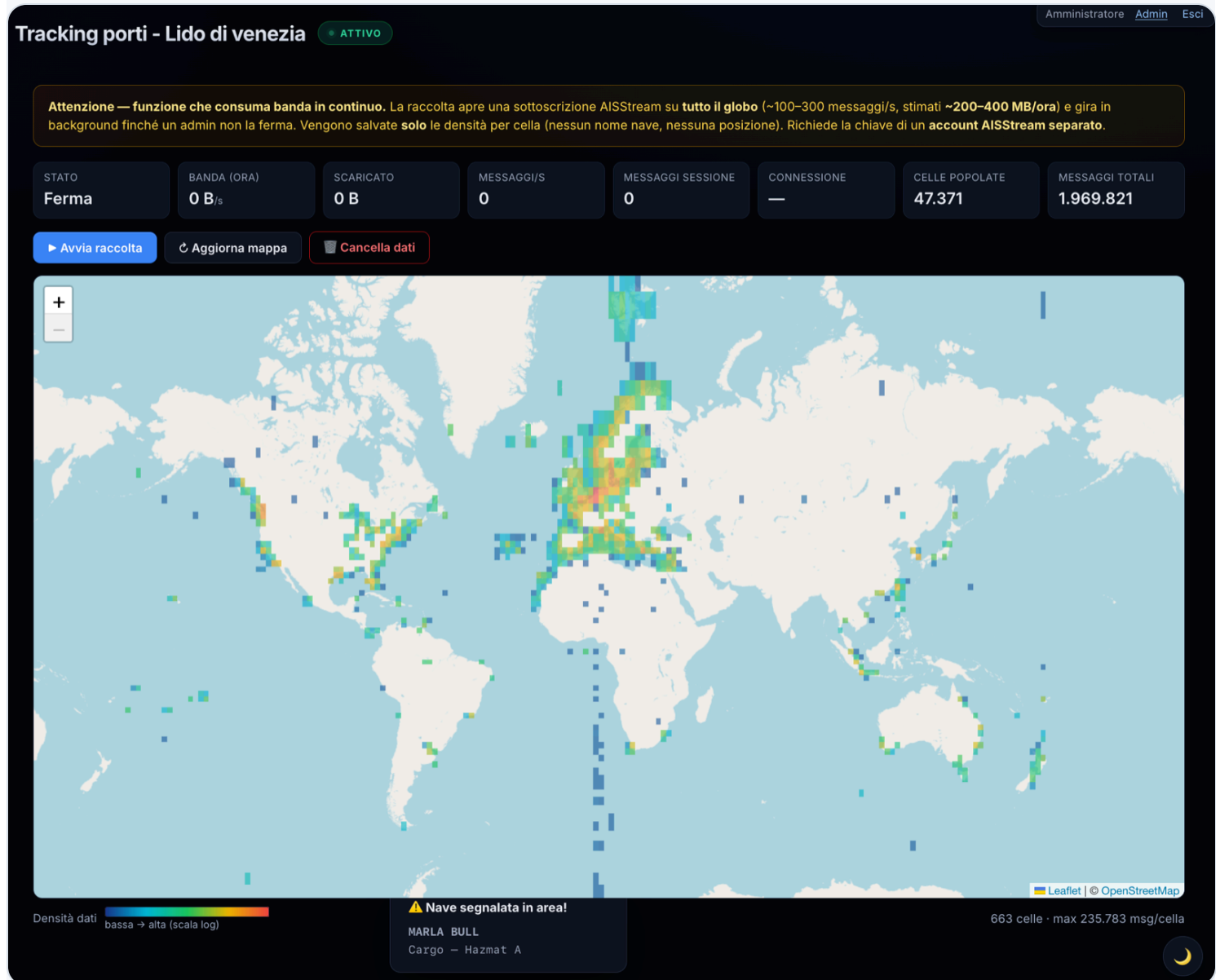
- monitoring **areas**;
- **followed ships**, **flagged ships** ★, and **muted ships** 🚫;
- **notification preferences** (app and Telegram) and **map display**, plus the **default area**.

In practice: if one member adds an area, follows a ship, or enables a notification, **the other members get it** on their next visit — and vice versa (write-through sync). What stays **personal** to each user: the **Telegram link** (their own chat) and the interface **language**.

Management (from the Admin page): a group has a **name**, a **description**, and **at least 2 members**. On creation you choose the **template user** whose settings the group starts from. You can **add/remove** members or **dissolve** the group.

A removal that would leave **only 1 member** is blocked: in that case, **dissolve** the group instead. If an administrator removes a user from a group, that user **keeps** everything that was shared up to that point (areas, ships, settings): they simply stop syncing with the others.

Coverage map — administrator controls



World coverage map: grid colored by AIS message density.

The Coverage map is visible read-only to all users (and even without login at `/heatmap`). Only **administrators** can additionally:

- **start** and **stop** data collection (**Start/Stop collection** buttons);
- see **real-time connection statistics** (bandwidth used, messages per second, populated cells...);
- **Refresh map** and **Clear data** (empties the collected grid).

How collection works: once started, it runs **in the background** on the server — even if no one has the page open — until an administrator stops it. It resumes on its own after a server restart. As a safety measure, it **automatically shuts off** if no user has been active for **10 minutes**.

Warning: while collection is active, the app **downloads data from the whole world** continuously (roughly **200–400 MB per hour**). The feature requires an **AISStream key from a separate account** (different from the one used for regular monitoring), set in `local.properties` as `HEATMAP_AIS_API_KEY` . Without that key, the feature stays off.

Risk model (signal weights)

Besides the **cargo-type weights** (editable by everyone in Settings), administrators can adjust **how many points each risk signal is worth** (AIS blackout, spoofing/position jump, dwell, draught increase, sanctions, PSC, GFW events, rendezvous, etc.) from ⚙ **Settings** → “⚙ **Risk model**” section.

- A **grid** with one field per signal: change the values and press  **Save weights. Immediate** effect, no restart needed. **Reset to default** restores factory values.
- Setting a weight to **0** disables that signal.
- You can save full configurations as **risk profiles** (*Risk profile* menu → *Save as...*) and recall them with *Apply* — useful for quickly switching between different setups (e.g. a more aggressive profile, or one tuned for areas with poor AIS coverage).

Detection thresholds and signal **multipliers** are not in the UI: they stay in the `app.config.properties` file (`RISK_*` keys).

System logs

Logs are **shared** and visible **only to administrators**, as tabs in Settings.

Activity log

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ATTIVO

AmministratoreAdminEsci

Indietro

GeneraliAreeIntegrazioni esterneParametriBackup / RipristinoLog attivitàLog APIDiagnostica AIS

Log attività

Registra le operazioni significative dell'app (stream, recupero dati, sanzioni, backup, errori) in un file con rotazione automatica (max ~5 MB). Attivo per impostazione predefinita.

OFFLINE

Svuota log

12:39:2016/07/26GFWGlobal Fishing Watch ok per MARLA BULL {"mmsi":538010265}

12:39:3716/07/26BERTHSRicalcolo incrementale banchine per arrivi/partenze {"aree":["taranto"]}

12:39:4116/07/26SCRAPEVesselFinder richiesto per MSC ELEONORA III {"mmsi":356167000,"id":9064750}

12:39:4116/07/26SCRAPEMarineTraffic richiesto per MSC ELEONORA III {"mmsi":356167000}

12:39:4116/07/26GFWGlobal Fishing Watch richiesto per MSC ELEONORA III {"mmsi":356167000}

12:39:4116/07/26SCRAPEVesselFinder ok per MSC ELEONORA III {"mmsi":356167000}

12:39:4216/07/26SCRAPEMarineTraffic ok per MSC ELEONORA III {"mmsi":356167000,"shipId":418155}

12:39:4716/07/26GFWGlobal Fishing Watch ok per MSC ELEONORA III {"mmsi":356167000}

12:41:0316/07/26AUTHAccesso: admin@local {"userId":1}

12:42:1816/07/26SCRAPEShipFinder richiesto per AQUILEIA {"mmsi":247290600}

12:42:1816/07/26GFWGlobal Fishing Watch richiesto per AQUILEIA {"mmsi":247290600}

12:42:1816/07/26SCRAPEMyShipTracking richiesto per AQUILEIA {"mmsi":247290600}

12:42:1816/07/26SCRAPEVesselFinder richiesto per AQUILEIA {"mmsi":247290600,"id":247290600}

12:42:1816/07/26SCRAPEMarineTraffic richiesto per AQUILEIA {"mmsi":247290600}

12:42:1816/07/26SCRAPEVesselFinder ok per AQUILEIA {"mmsi":247290600}

12:42:1816/07/26SCRAPEMyShipTracking ok per AQUILEIA {"mmsi":247290600}

12:42:1916/07/26SCRAPEMarineTraffic ok per AQUILEIA {"mmsi":247290600,"shipId":280743}

12:42:1916/07/26SCRAPEShipFinder ok per AQUILEIA {"mmsi":247290600}

12:42:2016/07/26GFWGlobal Fishing Watch ok per AQUILEIA {"mmsi":247290600}

12:42:3716/07/26KEY...3d34 | follow | WS_OPEN {"key":"...3d34","stream":"follow","op":"WS_OPEN","riconnessione":0}

12:42:3716/07/26KEY...3d34 | follow | OPEN_OK {"key":"...3d34","stream":"follow","op":"OPEN_OK"}

12:42:3716/07/26AISStream connesso {"area":"follow","riconnessione":0}

12:42:3716/07/26KEY...3d34 | follow | SUBSCRIBE {"key":"...3d34","stream":"follow","op":"SUBSCRIBE","navi":7}

12:42:4116/07/26SCRAPEPosizione MyShipTracking per nave seguita persa: MARLA BULL {"mmsi":538010265}

12:42:4216/07/26SCRAPEPosizione ShipFinder per nave seguita persa: MSC ELEONORA III {"mmsi":356167000}

12:42:4716/07/26SCRAPEPosizione ShipFinder per nave seguita persa: MARLA BULL {"mmsi":538010265}

12:42:4916/07/26SCRAPEPosizione ShipFinder per nave seguita persa: FADIQ {"mmsi":248592000}

12:42:5116/07/26SCRAPEPosizione ShipFinder per nave seguita persa: ROMAN E {"mmsi":353817000}

12:44:3616/07/26PORTO1 arrivi: MARLA BULL {"navi":1}

12:45:3716/07/26BERTHSRicalcolo incrementale banchine per arrivi/partenze {"aree":["lido_di_venezia"]}

Settings — Activity log: chronological record of the app's operations.

Records the app’s significant operations (streams, data fetching, sanctions, backups, errors) in a file with **automatic rotation** (max ~5 MB). On by default (**Activity log** toggle in the General tab, admin). The log can also be viewed from the 📦 **Activity log** overlay in the sidebar and can be **cleared**.

API log

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• ATTIVO

AmministratoreAdminEsci

← Indietro

Generali

Aree

Integrazioni esterne

Parametri

Backup / Ripristino

Log attività

Log API

Diagnostica AIS

• OFFLINE

☒ Auto-scroll

🗑 Cancellala log

#	ORA	METODO	PATH	STATUS	DURATA
1020270	12:46:26 16/07/26	GET	/api/telegram?lang=it	200 OK	2ms
1020271	12:46:28 16/07/26	DB	/ais/taranto/PositionReport	200 OK	1ms
1020272	12:46:31 16/07/26	DB	/ais/israele/StandardClassBPositionReport	200 OK	1ms
1020273	12:46:36 16/07/26	DB	/ais/israele/StandardClassBPositionReport	200 OK	0ms
1020274	12:46:37 16/07/26	AIS	/ais/follow/heartbeat	200 OK	0ms
1020275	12:46:37 16/07/26	AIS	/ais/monitoring/heartbeat	200 OK	0ms
1020276	12:46:38 16/07/26	GET	/api/app-config?lang=it	200 OK	6ms
1020277	12:46:41 16/07/26	DB	/ais/israele/PositionReport	200 OK	1ms
1020278	12:46:48 16/07/26	GET	/api/backups?lang=it	304 Not Modified	6ms
1020279	12:46:49 16/07/26	DB	/ais/israele/ShipStaticData	200 OK	1ms
1020280	12:46:52 16/07/26	DB	/ais/taranto/PositionReport	200 OK	1ms
1020281	12:46:53 16/07/26	DB	/ais/israele/StandardClassBPositionReport	200 OK	2ms
1020282	12:46:55 16/07/26	DB	/ais/israele/PositionReport	200 OK	2ms
1020283	12:46:56 16/07/26	DB	/ais/israele/StandardClassBPositionReport	200 OK	0ms
1020284	12:46:57 16/07/26	DB	/ais/israele/StandardClassBPositionReport	200 OK	1ms
1020285	12:46:57 16/07/26	GET	/api/app-log?limit=1000&lang=it	200 OK	5ms

Settings — API log: list of /api calls with method, path, and outcome.

Lists the application’s API calls in real time (method, path, status, time), useful for diagnostics. Sensitive request bodies (login, etc.) are **suppressed**: passwords are never logged.

Editing configuration files

Some advanced settings aren’t in the interface but in text files in the project folder. Open them with a text editor, change the values, and **restart the application** to apply them. Lines starting with # (or //) are comments and are ignored.

`local.properties` — keys and secrets

Contains the API key and initial preferences. Format `KEY=value` , one per line. **Must not be shared** (it contains the API key) and is in `.gitignore` . If it doesn't exist, copy it from `local.properties.example` .

Key	Meaning
<code>AIS_API_KEY</code>	AISStream.io key (required) — used by the monitoring areas' streams
<code>FOLLOW_AIS_API_KEY</code>	AISStream.io key for the followed ships stream. Best from a separate account (see note). Empty = reuses <code>AIS_API_KEY</code>
<code>HEATMAP_AIS_API_KEY</code>	Key of a separate AISStream account, used only for the Coverage map. Empty = feature disabled. Must be written "bare", with no comments on the same line
<code>BBOX_PRESET</code>	Area shown at startup (an area's key, e.g. <code>bari</code>)
<code>IMPORT_VF_DATA</code> / <code>IMPORT_MT_DATA</code>	<code>true</code> / <code>false</code> — enable VesselFinder / MarineTraffic import
<code>IMPORT_SF_DATA</code>	<code>true</code> / <code>false</code> — ShipFinder import + position to re-locate lost followed ships
<code>IMPORT_MST_DATA</code>	<code>true</code> / <code>false</code> — MyShipTracking import (second, independent backup position source)
<code>IMPORT_SANCTIONS</code>	<code>true</code> / <code>false</code> — screening against the OFAC SDN list
<code>IMPORT_SANCTIONS_EXTRA</code>	<code>true</code> / <code>false</code> — EU / UK OFSI / UN lists (only with <code>IMPORT_SANCTIONS</code>); default <code>true</code>
<code>IMPORT_PSC</code>	<code>true</code> / <code>false</code> — Port State Control screening (Paris/Tokyo MoU flags + banned ships)
<code>IMPORT_EQUASIS</code>	<code>true</code> / <code>false</code> — on-demand Equasis lookup in the ship detail
<code>EQUASIS_USER</code> / <code>EQUASIS_PASSWORD</code>	Equasis account credentials (free registration at equasis.org)
<code>IMPORT_GFW</code>	<code>true</code> / <code>false</code> — Global Fishing Watch enrichment; default <code>true</code>

Key	Meaning
GLOBAL_FISHING_WATCH_TOKEN	Global Fishing Watch API (Bearer) token. Data free for non-commercial use only
ADMIN_USERNAME / ADMIN_EMAIL / ADMIN_PASSWORD	Default administrator (re-created at startup if missing). Change the password on a server reachable by others
COOKIE_SECURE	true / false — sends the session cookie only over HTTPS; set to true behind TLS
SESSION_TTL_DAYS	Login session length in days. Default 30

💡 **Recommended: three keys from three separate AISStream accounts.** AISStream limits connections **per account, not per key**. The app opens three independent streams — **area monitoring** (AIS_API_KEY), **followed ships** (FOLLOW_AIS_API_KEY), and **coverage map** (HEATMAP_AIS_API_KEY). If two use keys from the **same account**, they compete for the same slot and one keeps getting rejected. Give each feature a key from a **dedicated account**.

app.config.properties — operating parameters

Tracking porti - Lido di venezia

ATTIVO

← Indietro

GeneraliAreeIntegrazioni esterneParametriBackup / RipristinoLog attivitàLog APIDiagnostica AIS

⚠ Le modifiche a questi parametri vengono scritte in `app.config.properties` e richiedono il **riavvio del server** per avere effetto (non basta ricaricare il browser). I segreti e le credenziali restano nel file `local.properties` ; i toggle di import e notifiche sono nel tab **Generali**.

Salva parametri

2 modifiche non salvate

RILEVAMENTO STATO NAVE

Soglia SOG (nodi) sotto cui la nave è considerata ferma

SOG_FERMA_KN

0,5

kn

Raggio (metri): ultime posizioni entro questo raggio → nave ormeggiata (isteresi anti-swing)

STILL_RADIUS_M

100

m

FINESTRE DI VISIBILITÀ

Ore: una nave in movimento viene mostrata in "Navi presenti" se vista in questa finestra

ACTIVE_WINDOW_HOURS

6

ore

Ore: una nave in porto (ormeggiata/all'ancora/ferma) resta in "Navi presenti" più a lungo

PORT_WINDOW_HOURS

24

ore

CONNESSIONE E POLLING

Millisecondi: attesa prima di riconnettersi ad AISStream dopo un errore

RECONNECT_DELAY_MS

5000

ms

Millisecondi: intervallo di aggiornamento del frontend (default 5 minuti)

POLL_INTERVAL_MS

300000

ms

Rilevamento disservizio AIS: se uno stream attivo non riceve messaggi per AIS_OUTAGE_SILENCE_MIN minuti, l'app interroga un monitor di uptime AISStream (progetto MIT github.com/buttermilkgreen/AISStream-Uptime) tramite la sua API /api/v1/status. Solo se anche quel monitor riporta il servizio non attivo viene

Settings — Parameters: configuration fields grouped by category with description.

Contains thresholds and parameters (time windows, radii, retention, berths, score weights). Format `KEY=value` , each parameter documented by a comment in the file. **You can also edit them from the interface** at ⚙ **Settings → Parameters** (more convenient). Either way, you need to **restart the server** to apply them (read only at startup). Examples:

Key	Meaning	Default
SOG_FERMA_KN	Speed (knots) below which a ship is "stationary"	0.5
ACTIVE_WINDOW_HOURS	Hours a moving ship stays among the "current" ones	6
PORT_WINDOW_HOURS	Hours a ship in port stays among the "current" ones	24
POLL_INTERVAL_MS	Interface refresh interval (ms)	300000
AIS_OUTAGE_CHECK	Enables AIS outage detection	true
AIS_OUTAGE_SILENCE_MIN	Minutes without signals before querying the uptime monitor	10
AIS_UPTIME_SELFHOST_URL	URL of your own self-hosted uptime monitor instance (queried first)	(empty)
AIS_UPTIME_URL	URL of the public uptime monitor, used as a fallback	https://aisuptime.buttermilkgreen.fyi
MAX_READINGS_PER_TYPE	Maximum readings kept per message type	10000
BERTH_CLUSTER_EPS_M	Mooring-to-berth clustering radius (meters)	80
BERTH_MIN_PTS	Minimum nearby moorings to form a berth	3

Key	Meaning	Default
BERTH_MIN_MOORINGS	Minimum moorings before characterizing a berth	10
BERTH_DOMINANT_PCT	Percentage a category must exceed to name the berth	60
BERTH_RECOMPUTE_MIN	Minutes between one automatic berth recomputation and the next	30
HEATMAP_GRID_DEG	Coverage map cell size, in degrees (~28 km)	0.25
HEATMAP_FLUSH_SEC	How often (seconds) counts are written to disk	10
RISK_*	Risk score weights and thresholds (see comments in the file)	various

bounding-boxes.json — area definitions

Lists the monitoring areas. **The recommended way to manage them is the 🗺️ Areas screen** (which rewrites this file on its own). You can edit it by hand for initial provisioning; if so, **restart** the app.

Each area:

```
"bari": { "name": "Porto di Bari", "keyword": "BARI", "sw": [40.95, 16.60], "ne": [41.30, 1
```

Field	Meaning
key (<code>bari</code>)	Internal area identifier (also used by <code>BBOX_PRESET</code>)
name	Name shown in the interface
<code>keyword</code>	(Optional, can be <code>null</code>) filters “Expected ships” by destination
sw	South-West corner [<code>lat</code> , <code>lon</code>] in decimal degrees
<code>ne</code>	North-East corner [<code>lat</code> , <code>lon</code>] in decimal degrees

Manual edits to this file while the app is running only take effect after a restart. If you use the Areas screen, the file’s formatting gets normalized (stays valid, but indentation changes).

Backup, restore, and deploy

- **Restoring** a database replaces **all** current data (irreversible): download a backup first. After restoring, data is reassigned to the correct area based on coordinates. Restoring **does not** re-trigger VesselFinder/MarineTraffic scraping (the data is already in the restored DB).
- **Coverage map** data lives in a **separate database**, exportable/importable on its own and still included in the full backup.
- **Auto-restore after a deploy:** the database is wiped whenever the application is updated. If, at startup, the DB **doesn’t exist** and there are **auto-backups** present (`data/backups/` folder), the app automatically restores the latest backup. Requires the backups folder to survive the deploy. Doesn’t trigger if the DB exists but was simply emptied with “Clear data”. Can be disabled with `AUTO_RESTORE_ON_DEPLOY=false` in `app.config.properties` .

Credits

AIS outage detection (the outage banner) relies on the **AISStream-Uptime** project by buttermilkgreen, an uptime monitor for the AISStream service. The app doesn't embed its code: it only queries the public API of its hosted instance (<https://aisuptime.buttermilkgreen.fyi>) to figure out whether a data silence is due to a service outage or simply a quiet area. The project is open source (MIT license) and you can **self-host it**: point `AIS_UPTIME_SELFHOST_URL` at your own instance's URL.